

* Topics to be Covered :-

* Arms Race and Cold War, Nuclear Threat (7A).

* Topic 11:-

- Nuclear Proliferation.

* INDIA & the Nuclear Question :- Changing Perception & Policy.

* Cold War and Arms Race :-

i) Arms race has been a regular feature of International Politics. With the Industrial Revolution nature of Arms Race kept on becoming more prominent. Advancement in technology led to the invention of weapon with greater potential of destruction. W.W.Ist is a testimony of the technological impact of destructiveness.

W.W.IInd ended with the use of Nuclear weapon.

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A new category of weapons along with biological and chemical (CBRN) are known as weapons of mass destruction. The invention of Nuclear weapons have change the very nature of warfare.

Bernard Brodie in his book Absolute weapon

suggest that from now onwards the objective of Militaries in the world will not be to seek victory in the war, but to avoid the war.

Winston Churchill also remarked that from now onwards security will be "the sturdy child of Terror."

J. Robert

1. Oppenheimer who is known as the father of Nuclear weapon, when observed the explosion, he automatically re-cited the verse from Gita - "Now, I am become the death, the destroyer of the World."

(2)

Thus, any ordinary student of International Politics knows that Nuclear weapons are not the weapons of War.

Why? -

B/c Nuclear War can never be won, and should never be fought.

This shows that nuclear weapons are the weapons of deterrence.

Deterrence means to deter & adversary from committing the act of Aggression.

Nuclear weapons played the critical role during Cold War.

Cold War remained Cold b/c of Nuclear weapon (use of Kenneth Waltz). However, the presence of Nuclear weapon & the logic of deterrence should not make us complacent that Nuclear War is not a possibility.

There is always a possibility of "Unthinkable". Hence, it is always better to think about Unthinkable & take preventive Action.

During Cold War, there have been occasions like - Cuban Missile Crisis when we could have slipped into the Nuclear War.

Similarly, time and again would gets trapped in the possibility of Nuclear war b/w India and Pakistan. A/c to US Administration, South Asia is the most dangerous Place in the World.

↳ we are sitting on the 'Atomic Clock', a place where there is a possibility of even the accidental war.

The present security and environment in South Asia is doubly dangerous.

- i) There is a possibility of Nuclear weapons Proliferating in the hands of Non-State Actors. → The biggest Security Challenge for India.
- ii) South Asia represent Nuclear Triad means it's not just about the Nuclear Arms race b/w India & Pakistan, China is also fast Strengthening its Nuclear bases (Shilas in Tibbet).

* Evolution of the Theory of Deterrence :-

- i) Deterrence by denial means no one should dare to attack.
When USA was the single country to possess Nuclear weapon then the strategy was preventing Conventional Attack / war by possessing Nuclear weapon.
- ii) Deterrence by Punishment means Second Strike Capability.
When USSR also developed the Capacity, it has race. the level of Nuclear threat for USA.

Why? -

- An experiment was conducted by Nuclear experts whether USSR will use Nuclear Weapon.

The study has shown that there is a probability of the use of Nuclear weapon b/c the Strategic Culture of Russia differs from USA.

The Concept of Deterrence by Punishment emerged. It later on came to be known as MAD (Mutually Assured Destruction)

MAD was the basis of strategic stability during Cold War b/w US and Russia. MAD is also known as Balance of Terror.

NOTE! - Balance of Power Vs Balance of Terror.

↓
Used for Conventional Warfare

↓
for Nuclear Warfare.

• The Doctrine of MAD represent two things! -

1) Ability for 2nd Strike.

↳ This requires the development of Nuclear Triad.

↓
It means Air bombers, land based system & Sea based Systems (Arms Race).

What is the Assumption behind Triad? -

As of now no country has the Capacity to destroy all the weapon systems of enemy in a 1st Strike.

Out of the 3 systems, the most important is sea based.

Why? -

- Most difficult to detect precisely.

ii) MAD Doctrine came to be imply ability of "Massive Retaliation". It means in the event of Nuclear attack, the targeted Country should be in a position to inflict "unacceptable Damage".

Unacceptable Damage is called as Counter Value Response. It means attacking the civilians.

NOTE! - • Counter Force Response - means attacking the forces in the battlefield.

- Counter Value Response - will require the Development of Strategic weapons. It means long Range weapons.
- Counter Force requires the development of Tactical weapons. Tactical means short range to be used in the battlefield.

What is the present Trend ? -

Since Vietnam War itself, US Strategist have been talking about the possibility of 1st Use. They have suggested the concept of Flexible Response. It means not necessarily Counter Value even prepare for Counter Force.

There was a concept of "Escalation ladder" means country should think about the possibility of limited Nuclear war.

There is a change in the approach of Nuclear weapons. From the weapon of Deterrence to the weapon of wars.

All Nuclear weapon States are trying to develop Missile Defense w/c implies the probability of 1st use.

However, still it is easier said than act.

Why? -

- B/c ~~the~~ 1st Use Requires immense capability specially precision. Country in the 1st Strike should be able to ^{All} precisely detect and target ¹ the Nuclear weapons of the Enemy Country -

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What is the ~~strength~~ trend in India? -

- Time and Again our leaders have mentioned that our Nuclear Policy is not in Silos. It means it can be changed a/c to the circumstances.

India going for Surgical Strike and then Balakot Strike. aimed at testing our capacity for Target Selection.

India is also acquiring Missile Defence System.

Since the Start of Ukraine War, the Nuclear Taboo is becoming weak.

It is believed that Nuclear Taboo has played a role in preventing the Nuclear War, a/c to **Nina Tannenwald**, there is a very dangerous scenario in the world b/c :-

- i) Multilateral Regimes are collapsing (INF)
- ii) USA has come out of ABMs Treaty.
- iii) The only bilateral Arms Control agreement b/w US and Russia is New START Treaty, w/c is due to expire.
- iv) NPT is facing the crisis of legitimacy.
- v) There is a danger of Nuclear Terrorism.
- vi) Nuclear Taboo is becoming weak.

Hence, Post Cold War Nuclear Security Environment is more challenging b/c of Multiple actors, there is a very high risk of Nuclear War.

• Global Nuclear Non-Proliferation Regime :-

Since, Nuclear Weapon threatened the Security and Create existential crisis, there have been attempts for :-

- a) Nuclear Arms Control. (Approach of US).
- b) Nuclear Disarmament. (to end the Nuclear War).
↳ (Approach of India).

* NPT — is the core pillar of Global Nuclear Non-Proliferation Order. It is the only Multi-lateral Agreement with almost Universal acceptability.

With the exception of India, Pakistan, Israel & South Sudan, all other countries in the world are the members. (North Korea are also out).

India has been the 1st trouble maker. Just b/c India is out, gives excuse to Pakistan to remain out.

Q) Critically Examine India's position w.r.t NPT, do you think that India should join NPT ? —

History of NPT :-

Reason for NPT — To protect/preserve US Hegemony.

What is the thought process Behind NPT ? —

US has to prevent the Proliferation of Nuclear weapons.

Why ?-

- More Countries with Nuclear weapons means more challenge to US Hegemony. Lesser Capacity of US to bargain.

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* Nth Nation Experiment :-

To predict the state at w/c the countries may be able to develop the Capacity.

What was the lesson ?-

- Sooner is better.

Hence, US came up with the programmes, earlier US made efforts for disarmament. However, the Environment was not conducive for disarmament. Hence, US went for Arms Control as a Pragmatic Approach.

• NPT is based on 3 Pillars !-

- i) Non-Proliferation.
- ii) Civilian Use of Nuclear Technology.
- iii) Disarmament.

* Non-Proliferation — preventing the Proliferation of the Nuclear weapons.

What Strategy US adopted ?-

Countries were divided into two types !-

- i) **Nuclear weapon State** — all those countries w/c have acquired the Capacity or Nuclear weapons by 1968. w/c coincidentally are P5 Countries / N5 Countries.

The Nuclear weapons of only these countries are considered as **De-jure or legal**.

Why ?-

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Since, Treaty came into force from 1st January 1970, it was a cut-off date.

ii) Non-Nuclear Weapon State¹ (NNWS) — Rest of the countries will be treated as NNWS w/c means they are not permitted to possess Nuclear Weapons.

The idea was to address "Nth nation Problem".

* India's PoV :-

— The treaty creates a world of Nuclear haves & have nots. It only addresses horizontal Proliferation but does not prevent Vertical proliferation.

* US Approach :-

- i) We have to take practical view i.e. the present Environment is not such that Nuclear weapon state will disarm themselves. Hence, we have to prevent the problem becoming bigger.
- ii) As far as Vertical Proliferation is concerned, US approach was go step by step :-
 - a) Bilateral Agreements b/w US and Russia.
 - b) CTBT as Next Step.

* Peaceful use of Nuclear Energy :-

NPT is a bargain. In exchange of countries giving up their nuclear option they will get full co-operation by the countries with advanced technologies for the peaceful use.

NPT propose a Watchdog Institution (IAEA) w/c will ensure that countries are not diverting the material & know how for weapon purposes, considering Nuclear technology as Dual Use.

Hence, Non-Nuclear weapon state will sign comprehensive safeguard Agreement with IAEA so that IAEA can carry inspections.

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What was India's Approach.? Should India have signed NPT?—

- i) Since India did not signed NPT, India could not get the access of Nuclear Technology.
- ii) India failed to develop Nuclear Technologies for Commercial Use of Thorium.
- iii) India vested lots of resources in developing the technologies w/c were already existing.

India should have been Smart enough.

↳ Learn from North-Korea.

North-Korea joined NPT gained know how accumulated material & came out of the Treaty.

Under the Treaty, Country could have left the treaty giving 3 months notice, in the interest of National Security.